

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

INTERNAL HACKATHON — MASTER INSTRUCTIONS HANDBOOK

Event	Detail
Competition	Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026 — Internal Round
Organised By	Chakravyuha Technical Club CRP Department
Campus	Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amaravati
Document	Master Instructions Handbook — All Rounds
Version	1.0 2026 Edition

■ IMPORTANT — READ CAREFULLY BEFORE REGISTERING

This document contains every official rule, eligibility criterion, submission guideline, and evaluation parameter for SIH 2026 Internal Hackathon. Non-compliance with any instruction may result in disqualification. All participants must read the full document.

Issued by Chakravyuha — Technical Club of Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amaravati

1. OVERVIEW & PURPOSE

The Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026 Internal Round is a campus-level selection event organised by Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amaravati to identify and nominate the most innovative student teams for the national SIH 2026 competition. This internal round ensures that only the best-prepared, rule-compliant, and genuinely innovative teams represent our institution at the national level.

Objectives

- Screen and shortlist high-quality problem statements from eligible student teams.
- Encourage cross-departmental collaboration and interdisciplinary innovation.
- Provide a fair, transparent, and merit-based selection process.
- Prepare shortlisted teams for the rigorous national SIH 2026 round.
- Limit first-year team representation to nurture quality over quantity.

2. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

General Eligibility

- All currently enrolled full-time B.Tech / M.Tech / MCA / MSc students of Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amaravati are eligible.
- Students must have a valid and active university enrollment number at the time of registration.
- Students who have previously represented Amrita at SIH nationals are still eligible but must declare this during registration.
- Students on academic probation or with active disciplinary proceedings are NOT eligible.
- Faculty members, staff, and external individuals CANNOT be part of any team.

Year-wise Eligibility

Year	Eligible?	Special Condition
1st Year (B.Tech)	✓ Yes	Max 20 teams composed entirely of 1st-year students
2nd Year (B.Tech)	✓ Yes	No separate cap; subject to overall team limit
3rd Year (B.Tech)	✓ Yes	No separate cap; subject to overall team limit
4th Year (B.Tech)	✓ Yes	No separate cap; subject to overall team limit
PG Students (M.Tech/MCA/MSc)	✓ Yes	Can form or join mixed teams
PhD Scholars	✗ No	Not eligible for SIH participation

Note: A 'mixed team' contains students from more than one academic year or more than one department. Mixed teams do not count towards the 1st-year team cap unless ALL members are 1st-year students.

3. TEAM FORMATION RULES

Team Size

- Every team must have a minimum of 2 members and a maximum of 6 members.

- Teams with fewer than 2 or more than 6 members will be automatically disqualified.
- Team size cannot be changed after the registration deadline.

Team Composition

- Teams may include students from different departments (cross-departmental teams are encouraged).
- Teams may include students from different academic years (mixed-year teams are allowed).
- Each team must designate one Team Leader who will be the primary point of contact.
- The Team Leader is responsible for all communications, submissions, and attending briefings.
- Every member must be from Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amaravati campus only.
- Students from other Amrita campuses (Coimbatore, Bangalore, Kochi, etc.) are NOT eligible.

■ SPECIAL RULE — FIRST-YEAR TEAM CAP

Only 20 teams composed ENTIRELY of 1st-year B.Tech students will be accepted.

- If ALL members of a team are 1st-year students → the team counts against the 20-team cap.
- If even ONE member is from 2nd year or above → the team does NOT count against the cap.
- Once 20 all-1st-year teams are registered (on a first-come, first-served basis), no further all-1st-year teams will be accepted.
- There is NO upper limit on mixed teams (teams with at least one non-1st-year member).
- 1st-year students CAN join mixed teams even after the 20-team cap is reached.

Team Uniqueness Rules

- A student can be part of ONLY ONE team. Registering with multiple teams will lead to disqualification of all associated teams.
- Two teams cannot submit the same problem statement or solution idea.
- Plagiarised ideas (from previous SIH editions, GitHub, or published work) will be disqualified.

Team Name

- Team name must be unique, professional, and not offensive or misleading.
- Team name must be 3–30 characters long (no special characters except hyphen and underscore).
- Team name cannot be changed after registration.

4. REGISTRATION PROCESS

How to Register

- 1 Form the team** — Decide all members before starting registration. Ensure eligibility of each member (enrollment, year, campus).
- 2 Choose a Problem Statement** — Browse the published SIH 2026 problem statements at sih.gov.in and select one that matches your team's skills. Note the PS ID.
- 3 Team Leader Registration** — The Team Leader must first create an account on the internal portal (link shared via Amrita webmail). Only one account per student.

4	Add Team Members — Enter the enrollment numbers of all team members. Each member will receive an email verification link and must verify within 24 hours.
5	Upload Idea Brief — Submit a 1–2 page PDF idea brief (template provided) describing your proposed solution.
6	Pay Registration Fee — Pay the nominal internal hackathon fee (if applicable) via the official payment gateway. Keep the receipt.
7	Final Submission — Click 'Submit Registration'. You will receive a confirmation email with your Team ID. This ID is mandatory for all future correspondence.

Registration Deadlines

Milestone	Date / Time	Mode
Portal Opens for Registration	To be announced via webmail	Online
Last Date for Team Registration	TBA — strictly enforced	Online
Last Date for Idea Brief Upload	TBA (same day as reg. deadline)	Online
Registration Confirmation	Within 48 hrs of submission	Email
Query Resolution Window	48 hrs after registration closes	Email

Important Registration Notes

- **Late registrations will NOT be entertained under any circumstances.**
- **Incomplete registrations (missing member verification, missing idea brief) will be rejected.**
- **Incorrect enrollment numbers will lead to automatic rejection — verify twice before submitting.**
- **Department changes or member replacements after submission are NOT permitted.**

5. PROBLEM STATEMENT GUIDELINES

Selecting a Problem Statement

- Teams must select from the officially published SIH 2026 problem statement list available at sih.gov.in.
- Each team can select only ONE problem statement.
- Problem statements span categories: Software Edition and Hardware Edition — select the one matching your team's capability.
- Teams opting for Hardware Edition must ensure access to required components/lab facilities.
- Two teams from the same institution cannot submit solutions for the same Problem Statement ID.

Idea Brief Requirements (Submitted at Registration)

- Maximum 2 pages (A4, PDF format only).
- Must include: Problem Statement ID, Problem Title, Proposed Solution Overview, Technology Stack, Team Name, Team ID.
- Font: Arial or Times New Roman, Size 11, Margins 2.5 cm all sides.
- Images/diagrams allowed but must fit within the 2-page limit.

- Do NOT include team members' names in the idea brief (blind review process).

Prohibited Problem Areas

Teams must NOT submit ideas that involve any of the following:

- Surveillance systems targeting individuals without consent.
- Misinformation generation or distribution tools.
- Systems that violate data privacy regulations (PDPB / GDPR).
- Projects that duplicate previously submitted internal SIH entries word-for-word.

6. HACKATHON ROUNDS & FORMAT

Round 1 — Idea Screening (Online Review)

Submitted idea briefs are reviewed by an internal panel of faculty and industry experts. Teams are evaluated on innovation, feasibility, relevance to the problem statement, and technical depth. Results will be communicated via email within the stipulated period. Shortlisted teams proceed to Round 2.

Round 2 — Presentation & Q&A; (On-Campus)

Shortlisted teams must present their solution (10-minute pitch + 5-minute Q&A;) to a panel of judges. Teams must prepare a PPT (max 12 slides) and a working prototype or demo video. Attendance of ALL team members is mandatory for this round.

Round 3 — Final Hackathon (36-Hour On-Campus Sprint)

Selected teams participate in a 36-hour continuous hackathon on campus. Teams must build and demonstrate a working prototype or software product. Mentors will be assigned. Judging criteria include functionality, innovation, scalability, UI/UX, and presentation. Winners are nominated for the national SIH 2026 round.

Round 3 — Logistics & Rules

- All team members must be present on campus for the entire 36-hour duration.
- Teams will be provided with a dedicated workspace, power outlets, and Wi-Fi.
- Teams must bring their own laptops, hardware components, and development tools.
- Internet access is permitted; however, the use of paid AI code-generation tools must be declared.
- Meals and refreshments will be provided at designated intervals.
- Sleeping arrangements will NOT be provided — teams are responsible for their own rest.
- Each team will have access to a dedicated mentor for technical guidance (not coding assistance).
- Code must be committed to a provided GitHub repository at every checkpoint.
- Teams cannot share code, datasets, or API keys with other teams during the sprint.
- Any form of plagiarism or external paid assistance will lead to immediate disqualification.

7. SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Round 1 Submission (Idea Brief)

- File format: PDF only. Max size: 5 MB.
- Filename convention: __IdeaBrief.pdf

- Upload via the official internal portal only. Email submissions will not be accepted.
- Only the Team Leader's portal account can upload the submission.

Round 2 Submission (Presentation)

- PPT/PPTX format, max 12 slides. File size under 20 MB.
- Filename: __Presentation.pptx
- Submit 24 hours before your scheduled presentation slot.
- Optional: Demo video (max 3 minutes, MP4, hosted on YouTube/Drive — share link in portal).

Round 3 Final Submission (Prototype)

- GitHub repository link (committed via provided account) — must be public or shared with judges.
- README.md must include: Problem Statement, Solution Overview, Tech Stack, Setup Instructions, Demo Link.
- Final presentation: 15 slides max. Include architecture diagram, demo screenshots, future roadmap.
- If hardware prototype: submit a 5-minute demo video in addition to the GitHub repo.
- All submissions must be made before the 36-hour deadline. Late commits will NOT be evaluated.

8. EVALUATION CRITERIA & SCORING

Criterion	Description	Max Marks
Innovation & Creativity	Originality of idea; novel approach to solving the problem	20
Technical Complexity	Depth of technology; difficulty of implementation	20
Feasibility	Practical viability; realistic implementation path	15
Relevance to Problem Statement	How accurately the solution addresses the given PS	15
Presentation & Communication	Clarity, confidence, and quality of pitch	10
Prototype / Demo Quality	Working-ness, completeness, and robustness of demo	15
Scalability & Impact	Potential for real-world deployment and broader impact	5
TOTAL	—	100

Judging Panel

- Round 1 panel: Internal faculty reviewers (minimum 3 per submission).
- Round 2 panel: Faculty experts + at least 1 industry professional.
- Round 3 panel: Mixed panel of senior faculty, industry experts, and past SIH winners.
- All judges' decisions are final and binding. No re-evaluation requests will be entertained.
- In case of a tie, the team with higher Innovation & Technical Complexity scores will be ranked higher.

9. CODE OF CONDUCT & DISCIPLINARY RULES

During the Hackathon

- Participants must maintain a respectful, professional, and collaborative environment.

- Harassment, bullying, discrimination, or offensive language of any kind will result in immediate disqualification.
- Vandalism of equipment, facilities, or other teams' work is a serious offense.
- Consumption of alcohol, tobacco, or any prohibited substances on campus is strictly banned.
- Participants must follow all campus rules and regulations in addition to hackathon-specific rules.

Academic Integrity

- All submitted work must be original and created during the hackathon (for Round 3).
- Referencing open-source libraries is permitted; the source must be credited in the README.
- AI-assisted code generation (GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, etc.) is permitted but must be declared in the submission.
- Copying code from another team, submitting pre-built projects, or misrepresenting work is disqualification-worthy.
- Organisers reserve the right to run plagiarism checks on any submission at any time.

Disqualification Triggers

A team will be IMMEDIATELY DISQUALIFIED for any of the following:

- **Misrepresentation of team member details or enrollment status**
- **Having more than 6 members or fewer than 2 members on a team**
- **A student registered in more than one team**
- **Submitting a plagiarised idea brief or copied project**
- **Harassment or misconduct against judges, volunteers, or other participants**
- **Tampering with other teams' work, code repositories, or submissions**
- **Violating campus rules or bringing prohibited items/substances on campus**
- **Attempting to bribe, influence, or contact judges outside the official process**

10. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & DATA PRIVACY

- All intellectual property created during the internal hackathon remains with the respective team.
- By participating, teams grant Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham the right to use their project title, brief description, and photos for institutional promotional purposes (website, social media, reports).
- Teams retain full rights to commercialise or patent their solutions independently.
- Teams must NOT include any personal data of real individuals in their demos or datasets without consent.
- Datasets used must be publicly available, anonymised, or owned by the team — declare this in the README.
- Solutions in sensitive domains (healthcare, finance, law enforcement) must adhere to applicable Indian regulations (PDPB, IT Act, etc.).

11. AWARDS, RECOGNITION & NOMINATION

Position	Award	Additional Benefit
■ 1st Place	Winner Trophy + Certificate + Cash Prize*	Nominated to National SIH 2026
■ 2nd Place	Runner-up Trophy + Certificate + Cash Prize*	Nominated to National SIH 2026
■ 3rd Place	3rd Place Trophy + Certificate	Nominated (if slots available)

Special Award	Best Innovation / Best UI / Best Social Impact	Certificate + Goodies
All Participants	Participation Certificate	Eligible for future club events

* Cash prize amounts will be announced separately. Prizes are subject to institutional approval.

National Nomination Policy

- The top 2 teams will be nominated to represent Amrita Amaravati at the national SIH 2026 round.
- Nominated teams must complete the official SIH national portal registration within the deadline provided by the organisers — failure to do so forfeits the nomination.
- Nominated teams must attend a mandatory preparation workshop organised by the college before the national event.
- The institution may nominate additional teams at its discretion based on PS availability at the national level.

12. MENTORSHIP & SUPPORT

- Every shortlisted team (from Round 2 onwards) will be assigned a dedicated faculty mentor.
- Mentors provide guidance on technical approach, presentation skills, and industry relevance — they do NOT write code or build the prototype for the team.
- Teams can request a mentor change once before Round 3 begins by emailing the organising committee.
- Industry mentors / guest experts may be available during Round 3 at specific time slots — schedule will be displayed at the venue.
- A help desk will be operational throughout Round 3 for logistical and technical environment queries.
- Any API credits, cloud resources, or hardware components needed must be arranged by the team — limited student developer credits may be available (first-come basis — check with organisers).

13. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQs)

Q: Can a 1st-year student join a team with 2nd/3rd-year students?

A: Yes. A 1st-year student can join any team. The 20-team cap only applies to teams where ALL members are 1st-year students. Mixed-year teams have no special cap.

Q: What if our team has 4 members from 1st year and 1 from 2nd year?

A: This team does NOT count toward the 20-team cap because not all members are 1st-years. It is treated as a regular team.

Q: Can we change our problem statement after registration?

A: No. Once the registration is submitted and confirmed, the problem statement cannot be changed.

Q: Can we have team members from different departments?

A: Yes — cross-departmental teams are fully allowed and encouraged.

Q: What if a team member is unavailable for Round 3?

A: Member changes are not permitted post-registration. If a member cannot attend Round 3, the remaining team members may continue, but any evaluation requiring all-member presence will be affected. Inform the organising committee at least 48 hours in advance.

Q: Is prior SIH experience required?

A: No. Any eligible student can participate regardless of prior experience.

Q: Can we submit a project we already started?

A: Round 1 idea briefs can describe pre-conceived ideas. However, Round 3 prototype must be substantially built during the 36-hour hackathon. Pre-written code that is directly submitted is disqualifying.

Q: How is the 1st-year cap enforced?

A: During registration, each member's year is auto-verified against the enrollment database. If all members are 1st-year, the team is flagged and counted against the 20-team cap. Registration is accepted on a first-come, first-served basis until the cap is reached.

14. CONTACT & GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

Organising Committee

Role	Contact	Medium
Primary Coordinator (Chakravyuha)	sih2026@chakravyuha.amrita.edu	Email
Faculty In-Charge (SIH 2026)	To be announced via webmail	Email / Office Visit
Technical Queries	tech@chakravyuha.amrita.edu	Email
Registration Issues	register@chakravyuha.amrita.edu	Email
Grievance Cell	grievance@chakravyuha.amrita.edu	Email

Grievance Redressal Process

- All grievances must be submitted in writing to the grievance email within 48 hours of the incident.
- Include your Team ID, member name, and a clear description of the issue.
- The committee will respond within 48 hours of receiving the grievance.
- Verbal complaints or social media posts will NOT be considered official grievances.
- The Faculty In-Charge's decision on all grievances is final.

15. DECLARATION & ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

By completing the registration process, every team member acknowledges and agrees to the following:

- **1.** I have read and understood all the instructions in this Master Instructions Handbook.
- **2.** I confirm that all details submitted during registration are accurate and truthful.
- **3.** I agree to abide by the Code of Conduct and all rules specified herein.
- **4.** I understand that violation of any rule may result in disqualification without appeal.
- **5.** I grant Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham the right to use my project information for institutional promotion.
- **6.** I confirm that my team's submitted idea is original and does not infringe on any intellectual property.
- **7.** I understand and accept that all judges' decisions are final and binding.
- **8.** I am aware of the 1st-year team cap rule and confirm my team's eligibility accordingly.

Team Leader Signature	Date	Faculty Coordinator Signature
_____	_____	_____

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